

SQUIRREL FEEDING SCHEDULE

(suitable for Western gray, Eastern fox and California ground squirrels*)

feeding amounts based on 5% of body weight	Age	Weight Range	Amount per Feeding	Times per Day	Hours between Feedings
	2 to 3 weeks	30 - 60 grams	1.5 – 3.0 cc	7 to 8 X/day	2.5 hours until over 60 grams and healthy, includes one mid-am feeding (e.g. 3 a.m.) (use Fox Valley 32/40**)
	3 to 4 weeks	60 – 90 grams	3.0 – 4.5 cc	6 to 7 X/day	3 – 3.5 hours
	4 to 5 weeks	90 – 130 grams	4.5 – 6.5 cc	5 X/day	3.5 – 4 hours (switch to Fox Valley 20/50 when squirrel reaches 100 grams**)
	5 to 6 weeks	130 – 150 grams	6.5 – 7.5 cc	4 to 5 X/day	4 hours
feeding amounts based on 6% of body weight	6 to 7 weeks	150 – 200 grams	9.0 – 12.0 cc	4 X/day	4 – 5 hours
	Start leaving 2 – 3 pieces of soft food 2-3 X/day, several large pieces of shelled nuts and 2-3 pieces of squirrel block daily				
	7 to 8 weeks	200 – 250 grams	12.0 – 15.0 cc	3 X/day	6 hours
	8 to 9 weeks	250 – 300 grams	15.0 – 18.0 cc	2 to 3 X/ day	6 – 8 hours
	9 to 11 weeks	300 – 420 grams	18.0 – 25.0 cc	2 X/day	6 – 8+ hours
	11 to 12 weeks	420 – 450+ grams	20.0 – 25.0 cc	1 X/day	should be weaning; amount of formula will depend on how much solid food is eaten
	12 to 16 weeks	450+ grams		2 X/day	solid food and nuts

*This chart is based on Western Grays; smaller species may go to less frequent formula feedings, solid food, and wean sooner. Gray squirrels should gain from 2-3 grams per day at the age of 2-3 weeks, 4-7 grams per day at 4-6 weeks, and about 8-10 grams per day when older. Smaller squirrel species gain at a rate of about 2-4 grams per day under 100 grams and 5-6 grams per day over 100 grams. Feeding schedules for Douglasses, flyers and chipmunks are available.

Formula differences: **Fox Valley 32/40 is 32% protein and 40% fat; **Fox Valley 20/50** is 20% protein and 50% fat. Some babies have done better on the 32/40 for a longer period than others, so if your little one objects to the 20/50, or doesn't do well on it, you can try that. Move very gradually from 32/40 to 20/50 formula. You can mix the two formulas to gradually have the full 2:1 mix of 20/50 (i.e. mix both 32/40 and 20/50 at the 2:1 ratio, then blend over several days with less 32/40 each day).

All feeding amounts are estimates; watch feces color and form and weight gain/loss for signs of under/over-feeding (overfeeding causes soft-stool, sometimes normal color, but often white or greenish). Firm, light to dark gold, round or oblong pellets indicate amounts and schedule are fine.

Always follow the number of feeding times per day, and try to keep a consistent schedule as far as length of time between feedings. There should be 3.5 hours minimum between feedings once squirrels are 3 weeks old or over. You can give 5.5 - 7%, or a little over, for older (6 weeks up) babies, if healthy and no stool problems. Douglas, flyers, and chipmunks need 7%, or a little over, beginning at 4-5 weeks, since their metabolism is faster than that of the larger species.